India's Online Consumer Electronics Accessories Market: Size, Growth, and Distribution Trends 2024–2026

1 Executive Summary

India's online consumer electronics accessories market —spanning earbuds/TWS, smartwatches, chargers, cables, and power banks —is on a sustained growth trajectory with the broader mobile accessories segment valued at approximately USD 6.86 billion in 2025 and projected to reach USD 14.66 billion by 2034 at an 8.54% CAGR [1]. Online channels now command 58.4% of total accessories distribution [1], making e-commerce the dominant route to market. However, category performance is sharply divergent: USB chargers ($2.30 billion, 8.9% CAGR) [2] and TWS earbuds (>$1.3 billion) [3] anchor the market, while smartwatches have contracted dramatically to $780 million in 2025 —a 43.9% decline from the 2023 peak [4] (Livemint, citing IDC India).

The most transformative structural shift is the rise of tier-2 and tier-3 city demand, which now accounts for over 65% of Amazon India's consumer electronics orders [5] and is projected to represent 64% of all online shoppers by FY2030 [6]. Yet online retail penetration in these markets remains just 4% [7], signaling enormous headroom. Quick commerce is compounding this expansion by capturing sub-₹1,000 impulse purchases —earbuds, chargers, and cables —with the channel growing approximately 75% YoY in 2025 [8] and brands like Nu Republic already deriving 60% of sales from it [9].

Festival-season concentration remains a defining market feature: the 2025 festive season generated ₹1.24 lakh crore in e-commerce GMV, a 31% YoY surge, with consumer electronics growing 35–43% YoY [10]. The first week alone captured 48% of total festive GMV [10]. For brands and platforms, the actionable imperative is to align inventory, pricing, and channel strategy around the September–October window while investing in non-metro logistics and quick-commerce partnerships to capture the next wave of growth from India's under-penetrated smaller cities.

2 Introduction

India's online consumer electronics accessories market —encompassing earbuds/TWS, smartwatches, chargers, cables, and power banks —has emerged as one of the fastest-evolving segments of the country's digital commerce ecosystem. Fuelled by over a billion mobile connections [11], rising smartphone penetration, and aggressive brand competition, the market sits at the intersection of affordability-driven demand and rapid channel innovation.

The broader Indian mobile accessories market, including chargers and data cables, was valued at approximately $9.83 billion in 2023 and is expected to reach $17.75 billion by 2030, growing at a CAGR of 8.2% [9]. A narrower definition of the mobile accessories market pegs the 2025 value at USD 6.86 billion, projected to reach USD 7.45 billion in 2026 and USD 14.66 billion by 2034 at a CAGR of 8.54% [1]. Crucially, online channels now command 58.4% of total accessories distribution [1], making e-commerce the dominant route to market and the primary focus of this report. This analysis excludes smartphones, laptops, and offline retail, concentrating instead on the online-only dynamics of the five core accessory categories across the 2024–2026 window.

3 Category-Level Performance: 2024–2026

The five accessory categories tracked in this report are at markedly different stages of maturity, with USB chargers and TWS earbuds leading in absolute size while smartwatches undergo a painful correction and power banks remain a niche segment.

TWS/Earbuds represent the largest and most dynamic category. According to Counterpoint Research, India's TWS market surpassed $1.3 billion in revenue in 2024, with shipments rising 14% year-on-year, driven by affordable offerings, seasonal sales events, and expanding use cases [3]. However, the market matured rapidly: full-year 2025 recorded only a modest 1% YoY shipment growth, though momentum strengthened in Q4 2025 with festive demand and AI-led feature upgrades driving a 12% YoY recovery [12]. ANC-enabled devices grew 24% YoY and spatial audio capabilities expanded with 67% YoY growth in 2025, signalling a clear premiumization trend [12]. boAt maintained market leadership with a 33% share, followed by Boult and Noise, while Chinese brands grew 33% YoY to capture 16% share and realme emerged as the fastest-growing brand among the top 10 with 55% YoY growth [3].

Smartwatches have experienced the sharpest reversal. Counterpoint Research reports that India's smartwatch shipments tumbled 30% YoY in 2024 after years of steady growth [13]. According to Livemint citing IDC India data, 28.9 million smartwatches were sold in 2025 generating $780 million in revenue —a stark 43.9% decline from the $1.39 billion record set in 2023 [4]. Budget-segment saturation and a lack of compelling upgrade cycles

have weighed heavily on this category, though average selling prices increased for the first time since 2019 [14], hinting at a possible quality-over-quantity pivot.

USB Chargers form the steadiest growth pillar. The India USB charger market was valued at USD 2.30 billion in 2025 and is expected to grow at a CAGR of 8.90% during 2026–2035 [2]. The transition to USB-C standards and fast-charging adoption across device categories continue to underpin demand.

Power Banks remain a comparatively small segment. The India power bank market was valued at USD 151.12 million in 2023 and is predicted to reach USD 188.97 million by 2030 at a CAGR of 2.8% [15], reflecting modest but steady replacement-driven demand.

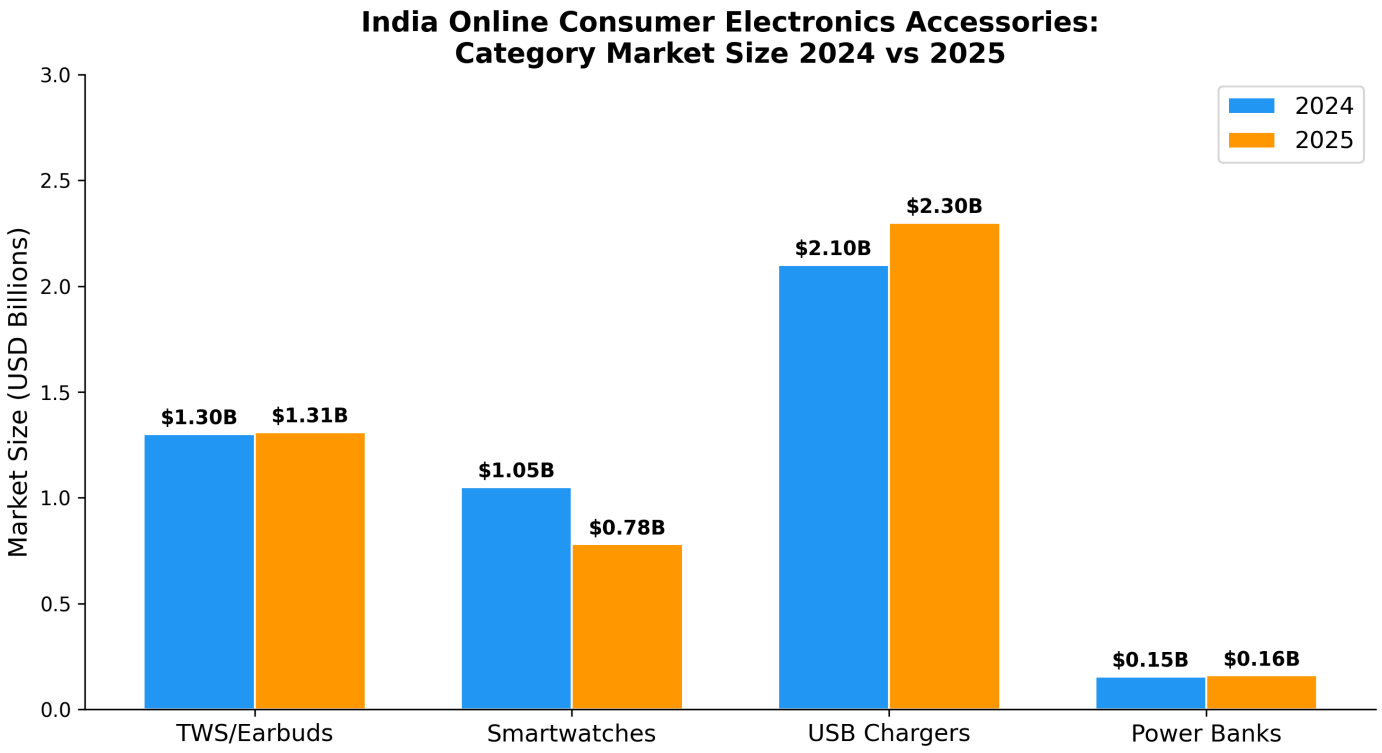


Figure 1: Category Market Size Comparison

Chart Explanation: This chart compares the estimated market size of the four core accessory categories in 2024 and 2025. USB chargers lead in absolute value at $2.30 billion [2], while TWS earbuds represent the largest high-growth segment at over $1.3 billion [3]. The smartwatch category's sharp revenue contraction from approximately $1.05 billion to $780 million [4] stands out as the most significant year-on-year decline.

Category	2024 Size (Est.)	2025 Size	YoY Trend	CAGR / Outlook
TWS/Earbuds	>$1.3B [3]	~$1.31B (+1% YoY) [12]	Maturing; Q4 recovery	Premiumization underway
Smartwatches	~$1.05B (est.) [13]	$780M [4]	Sharp decline (-43.9% from 2023 peak)	Budget saturation; ASP rising [14]
USB Chargers	~$2.1B (est.)	$2.30B [2]	Steady growth	8.9% CAGR 2026–2035 [2]
Power Banks	~$155M (est.)	Growing modestly [15]	Stable	2.8% CAGR to 2030 [15]

Table: Category-Level Market Size and Growth Summary, 2024–2025

4 Amazon India and E-Commerce Platform Dynamics

The competitive landscape among India's e-commerce platforms is intensifying, with direct implications for how accessories reach consumers. Flipkart leads India's online retail market with approximately 32.4% share, followed

by Amazon at 24.3% as of 2023 [16]. Together, Flipkart and Amazon accounted for 56% of e-commerce value share in 2025 [17]. However, the competitive gap is widening: Flipkart's monthly active user (MAU) lead over Amazon has nearly doubled from about 9 percentage points in 2022 to 17 percentage points by mid-2026, with Amazon's MAU base declining year-on-year while Flipkart's grew 15% [17].

Both platforms have responded with aggressive pricing strategies targeting the accessories segment. Flipkart introduced zero commission on products priced below ₹1,000 in November 2025 and extended it to fashion across all price points in July 2026 [18]. Amazon followed with a waiver of referral fees for products below ₹1,000 in March 2026 and expanded zero referral fee coverage to 12.5 crore products [18, 19]. These moves are particularly significant for accessories —earbuds, chargers, cables, and power banks frequently fall within the sub-₹1,000 price band, making them direct beneficiaries of reduced platform fees.

Meanwhile, Meesho's value-commerce share rose to 13% of overall online commerce in H1 2026, up from 9% in H1 2023 [18], intensifying competition in the affordable accessories segment. The online channel's 58.4% share of total accessories distribution [1] underscores that e-commerce is not merely a complementary channel but the primary marketplace for this product category. Nearly three out of four TWS devices were sold online in 2024 [3], reinforcing the centrality of digital platforms.

5 Tier-2 and Tier-3 City Demand Expansion

Perhaps the most transformative structural shift in India's online accessories market is the rapid rise of non-metro demand. The share of online shoppers from tier-2 and tier-3 cities increased from 46% in FY2020 to 56% in FY2024 and is projected to reach approximately 64% by FY2030 [6]. Over 65% of Amazon India's consumer electronics demand now comes from tier-2 and tier-3 cities, with mobile phones reaching an even higher 70% share [5]. Nearly 70–80% of Amazon's new customers come from non-metro cities, and 70% of new Prime customers originate from tier-II and tier-III cities [20].

The festive season data makes this shift even more vivid. During Diwali 2025, tier-III cities alone accounted for 50.7% of all orders; combined with tier-II (24.8%), non-metro India represented nearly three-quarters of total order volume [21]. Electronic wearables saw a 75% jump in order volumes in tier-3 cities during the 2025 summer sales period [22], and tier-2 and tier-3 cities drove 66% of new direct-to-consumer (D2C) orders in FY2026 [23]. In Q4 2024, tier-3 cities outpaced metros and tier-2 cities in tech and durables growth, expanding at 10% compared to 7% in tier-1 and 6% in tier-2 [24].

However, important structural differences persist. The average order value in smaller cities is ₹830, less than half the ₹1,714 recorded in the largest cities [25]. Cash-on-delivery remains dominant in tier-3 markets, though prepaid payment adoption has climbed to nearly 34.5%, compared to 46% in metros [26]. Critically, online retail penetration in tier-2+ markets remains at only about 4%, compared to mid-double-digit penetration in metros [7], suggesting enormous headroom for growth. Cities such as Bardhaman, Cuttack, East Godavari, Krishna, and Medinipur have emerged as notable growth hubs [27], illustrating that demand is dispersing well beyond the traditional metro-adjacent tier-2 centres.

6 Quick-Commerce as an Emerging Channel

Quick commerce has rapidly evolved from a grocery-delivery model into a meaningful distribution channel for consumer electronics accessories. According to a Bernstein report, quick commerce in India was estimated to see approximately 75% YoY growth in 2025, driven by expansion into newer categories beyond grocery and into tier-2+ cities [8].

The sweet spot for electronics purchases via quick commerce is below ₹1,000, according to Counterpoint Research —earbuds, chargers, cables, and power banks dominate, while higher-priced items still flow through traditional e-commerce [9]. This price-point alignment makes accessories a natural fit for the impulse-purchase, instant-delivery model. Some brands have already shifted substantial volumes to the channel: Nu Republic derives approximately 60% of its sales from quick-commerce platforms, while Stuffcool reports that quick commerce accounts for about 25% of their sales, with daily volumes growing from 30–40 to 90–100 units per day [9].

Zepto's non-grocery sales, including electronics accessories, more than doubled month-on-month, with nearly 15% of its approximately $1.2 billion annualised gross sales coming from non-grocery categories. Earphones and accessories are clocking double-digit growth on a quarterly basis [28]. Online channels accounted for 34% (approximately ₹11,000 crore) of consumer electronics sales in FY24, up from 32% in 2023, with quick commerce emerging as a growing sub-channel within this [8]. While quick commerce is unlikely to displace traditional e-commerce for higher-value accessories, it is carving out a significant and growing niche for sub-₹1,000 impulse purchases, effectively expanding the total addressable market by converting offline convenience-store purchases into digital transactions.

7 Festival-Sale Seasonality and GMV Concentration

Festive-season sales remain the single most important demand catalyst for India's online accessories market, with September–October consistently generating the sharpest spikes in order volumes and GMV.

In 2024, India's e-commerce sector recorded approximately $14 billion (over ₹1.18 lakh crore) in total festive-season GMV, marking a 12% YoY increase [29]. Amazon and Flipkart together recorded ₹54,500 crore in the first week alone (September 26–October 2), a 26% YoY increase, with mobile phones (38%) and electronics and consumer durables (21%) accounting for nearly 60% of spending [30]. The 2025 festive season surged even more dramatically: total e-commerce GMV reached ₹1.24 lakh crore, a 31% jump from 2024's ₹94,800 crore [10]. Consumer electronics and appliances were the strongest performers, with YoY GMV growth between 35% and 43% [10]. The first week of 2025 festive sales alone generated ₹60,700 crore, accounting for 48% of total festive GMV [10].

The seasonality patterns are striking. According to ET BrandEquity, mobiles have the most dramatic seasonality swing with a Seasonality Index Difference of 1.7, peaking at a monthly index close to 2.3 in September–October. Electronics follows closely with a difference of 1.3, peaking near 2.0 [31]. In 2024, the Diwali week and the week prior accounted for 60% of festive electronic product sales [32]. The 2025 festive season was described as the best period for consumer electronics retailers since 2021, with a 5–7% increase in sales by volume and more than 10% by net value over 2024 [33].

Early indicators for the 2026 festive season are encouraging: e-commerce order volumes grew 20% during the first four days of the festive sale (September 26–29) compared to the same period in 2025 [34].

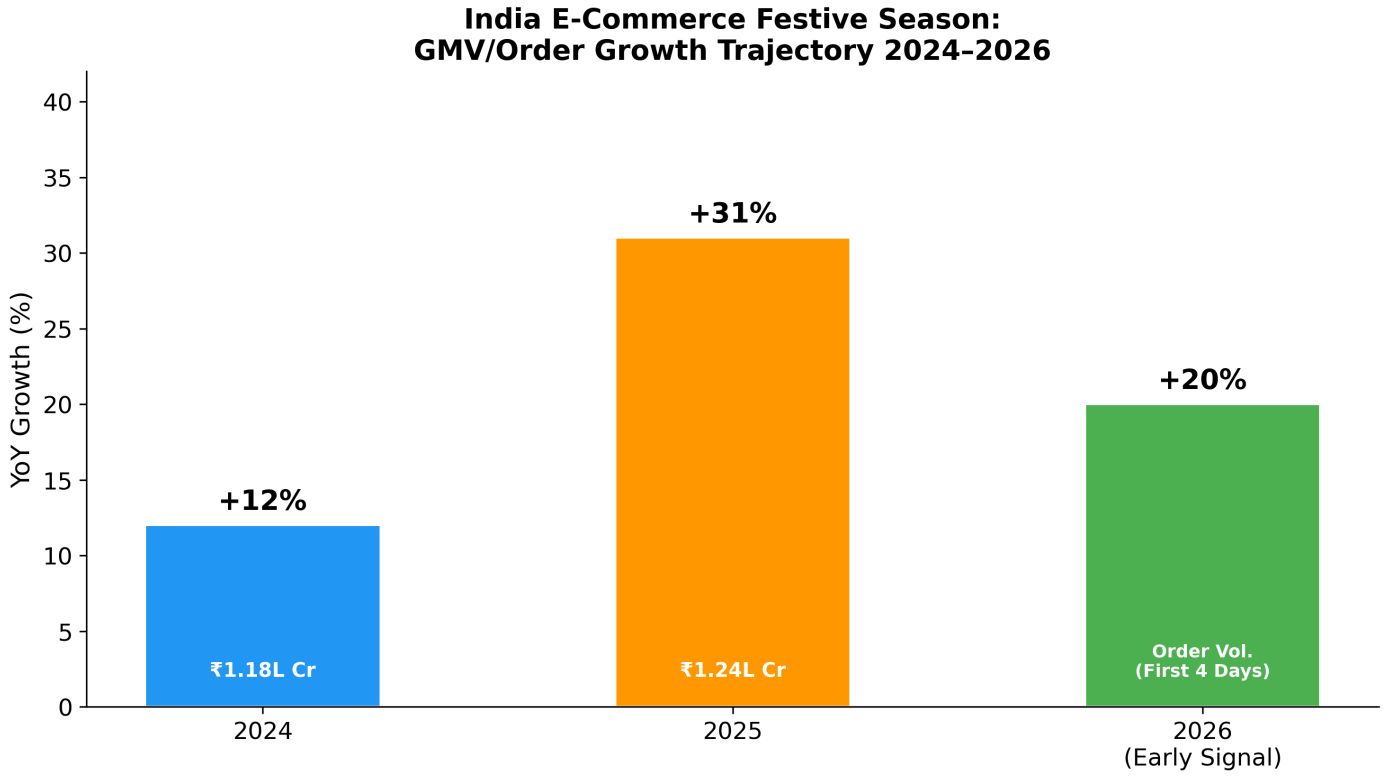


Figure 2: Festive Season GMV Growth

Chart Explanation: This chart illustrates the accelerating trajectory of India's e-commerce festive season. The 2024 season grew 12% YoY to ₹1.18 lakh crore [29], while 2025 surged 31% YoY to ₹1.24 lakh crore [10]. The 2026 early signal of 20% order volume growth in the first four days [34] suggests continued momentum, though full-season figures are not yet available.

8 Growth Drivers and Market Catalysts

Several structural and cyclical forces are converging to sustain growth in India's online accessories market through 2026 and beyond.

Smartphone base and replacement cycles form the foundational demand driver. With over a billion mobile

connections [11], every smartphone sold or upgraded creates recurring demand for chargers, cables, earbuds, and protective accessories. The USB-C transition mandated across device categories is accelerating charger and cable replacement cycles, supporting the 8.9% CAGR projected for the USB charger segment [2].

Affordability and brand competition keep the market accessible. The ₹1,500–₹2,000 price band experienced the highest YoY growth in TWS in 2024 [3], and the zero-commission strategies adopted by Amazon and Flipkart for sub-₹1,000 products [18, 19] further reduce the effective cost of accessories for consumers. Indian brands like boAt, Boult, and Noise dominate the value segment, while Chinese brands are growing rapidly at 33% YoY [3], ensuring intense price competition that benefits consumers.

Digital infrastructure and payment adoption are reducing friction in smaller markets. Prepaid payment adoption in tier-3 markets has climbed to nearly 34.5% [26], and the expansion of logistics networks to non-metro areas has enabled over 60% of e-commerce shipments to originate from tier-2 and tier-3 cities [6]. Amazon's expansion of zero referral fee coverage to 12.5 crore products [19] and its focus on making technology accessible "down to the last pin code" [5] reflect the strategic priority platforms are placing on smaller-city penetration.

Channel diversification through quick commerce is expanding the total addressable market. By capturing impulse and urgent-need purchases that previously went to local offline stores, quick-commerce platforms are adding incremental volume to the online accessories ecosystem, particularly for sub-₹1,000 items [9].

9 Outlook and Key Takeaways

India's online consumer electronics accessories market is poised for sustained growth through 2026, underpinned by an 8–9% CAGR at the aggregate level [1, 9] and structural tailwinds from tier-2/3 city adoption, quick-commerce expansion, and festive-season demand concentration. USB chargers and TWS earbuds will continue to anchor the market in absolute terms, while the smartwatch segment faces an uncertain recovery path after its sharp 2024–2025 correction [13, 4]. Premiumization in TWS —evidenced by the growth of ANC and spatial audio features [12] —suggests that revenue growth can outpace unit growth even as the market matures.

The twin engines of tier-2/3 city expansion and quick-commerce adoption represent the most significant medium-term opportunities. With online retail penetration in non-metro markets at only about 4% [7] and quick-commerce growing at approximately 75% YoY [8], both channels have substantial runway. For platforms and brands alike, the strategic imperative is clear: win in smaller cities with affordable, value-driven product portfolios delivered through increasingly diverse and faster channels, while leveraging the September–October festive window — which concentrates nearly half of annual festive GMV in a single week [10] —as the critical demand catalyst each year.

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